9. Erich Honecker, Aus Meinem Leben (German edition, 1980). p.202

10. Frankfurt Domestic Radio. 18 August 1961

11. US Foreign Relations Documentation 1961. pp.154–155

Plugging the Gaps

1. The end of construction works came as a small relief to Markus Wolf, a lean and handsome intelligence officer who ran East Germany's foreign espionage division. Often regarded as one of the most well-known spymasters during the Cold War, Wolf was known in the West as 'the man without a face' due to his elusiveness. Remarkably, he wasn't informed about the erection of the wall by Erich Mielke and, after 13 August, found the task of running agents across into West Berlin increasingly problematic. The usual process of collecting intelligence – easily contacting sources in the West and personal meetings – faced terrific difficulties and it took months before intelligence operations could properly resume. Wolf lamented the 'paradoxical situation' in which the controls imposed by the GDR were 'far more draconian and difficult to negotiate than those of the West Germans'.

2. They were something of a novelty at the time and resembled an over-sized armoured truck with a crew of four. Two men sat in the driver's cab and two more were placed inside the truck on which a turret was mounted. The water tank was about 3 metres long and had an approximate capacity of 3,000 litres. Although not invented by the East German communists, the border guards put them to excellent use. Ironically, the trucks were developed in Italy as a method of dispersing communist demonstrators, the only difference being the Italians often added red dye into the water so that clothing was ruined, and a person could easily be identified by the police the next day.